

3-YEAR Plan for 101 Acre Baxter Property

Commercial Profit to Community Profit Conversion Plan

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Proposal:

3-Year Plan to convert 101 acre parcel of land located in Deerfield illinois into a regenerative farm which can provide educational services, create jobs, provide abundant food for the surrounding communities, reduce carbon footprint, create an oasis for wildlife, and jumpstart sustainability for deerfield residents.



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Outline:

1. Conduct a feasibility study: Before starting any development, it's important to conduct a feasibility study to determine if the project is viable. The feasibility study should consider factors such as soil type, water availability, the suitability of the land for farming, and the potential market for products.
2. Develop a business plan: Once the feasibility study is complete, the next step is to develop a business plan. The plan should outline the goals and objectives of the farm, as well as the strategies to achieve them. The business plan should also include financial projections, marketing strategies, and the organizational structure of the farm.
3. Choose a regenerative farming model: Regenerative agriculture is an approach to farming that focuses on building soil health, improving ecosystem services, and enhancing biodiversity. There are several regenerative farming models to choose from, including agroforestry, permaculture, and rotational grazing. Choose a model that is appropriate for the local climate, soil type, and market demand.
4. Build the necessary infrastructure: Depending on the chosen farming model, the necessary infrastructure will vary. However, some common infrastructure needs include irrigation systems, animal housing, equipment storage, and processing facilities.
5. Implement regenerative farming practices: Once the infrastructure is in place, it's time to implement regenerative farming practices. This includes using cover crops, crop rotations, composting, and reducing the use of pesticides and fertilizers. It also involves incorporating livestock into the farming system to help manage weeds and build soil health.
6. Establish a farm-to-table operation: A farm-to-table operation involves growing food and selling it directly to consumers. This helps to reduce the carbon footprint of the farm by eliminating the need for transportation and processing. It also provides a higher profit margin for the farm.
7. Provide educational services: The regenerative farm can also provide educational services to the local community. This can include workshops, field trips, and farm tours. The educational services can also be extended to schools and other organizations in the area.

8. Create jobs: The development of a regenerative farm will create jobs in the local community. The farm will require skilled workers such as farmers, animal husbandry experts, and processing technicians. It will also create jobs in marketing, sales, and administration.
9. Create an oasis for wildlife: Regenerative agriculture creates a diverse ecosystem that provides habitat for a variety of wildlife. The farm can be designed to provide habitat for endangered species, birds, and other wildlife.
10. Jumpstart sustainability for Deerfield residents: The development of a regenerative farm can serve as a model for sustainable agriculture in Deerfield. It can inspire residents to adopt regenerative practices in their own homes and businesses, reducing their carbon footprint and improving the local ecosystem.

Feasibility Study:

1. Determine the physical characteristics of the land: Collect data on the physical characteristics of the land such as soil type, slope, water availability, and drainage. This information is essential in determining the suitability of the land for farming.
2. Analyze the climate: The climate of the region is an important factor in determining the viability of a regenerative farm. Analyze the average temperature, precipitation, and growing season to determine the type of crops that can be grown on the land.
3. Identify the local market demand: Determine the local market demand for organic and regenerative farm products. Analyze the local demographics, consumer preferences, and existing market competition.
4. Assess the regulatory environment: Review the regulatory environment in Deerfield, IL, to determine the rules and regulations that must be followed to establish a regenerative farm. Determine the zoning regulations, building codes, and permitting requirements for farming operations.
5. Determine the financial viability: Conduct a cost-benefit analysis to determine the financial viability of the regenerative farm. Consider the costs of land purchase or lease, infrastructure development, equipment purchase, and ongoing operational expenses. Analyze the potential revenue streams such as crop sales, livestock sales, and value-added products.

6. Consider potential risks: Identify and assess potential risks to the success of the regenerative farm, such as extreme weather events, pest infestations, and market fluctuations.
7. Evaluate the community impact: Analyze the potential impact of the regenerative farm on the local community. Consider the social, economic, and environmental benefits and potential drawbacks of the farm.
8. Determine the organizational structure: Determine the organizational structure of the farm, including the legal structure, management team, and staffing needs.
9. Develop a plan: Based on the findings of the feasibility study, develop a plan for the regenerative farm that outlines the goals, objectives, and strategies for the project. The plan should include financial projections, marketing strategies, and operational details.

3-YR Business Plan:

Executive Summary:

The primary goals of the farm are to provide educational services, create jobs, provide abundant food for the surrounding communities, reduce carbon footprint, create an oasis for wildlife, and jumpstart sustainability for Deerfield residents. The farm will operate under a regenerative agriculture model, which emphasizes the restoration and revitalization of the land through sustainable farming practices.

Organizational Structure:

The regenerative farm will operate as a limited liability company (LLC) with a management team comprising of a farm manager, education and outreach coordinator, marketing and sales manager, and operations manager. The management team will report to the farm's owners (established under the Board of Trustees) who will be responsible for the overall strategic direction of the business.

Marketing Strategy:

The regenerative farm will market its products to the surrounding communities through various channels such as farmer's markets, CSAs (Community Supported Agriculture), local grocery stores, and online sales. The farm will also conduct educational events and workshops to build awareness and interest in regenerative farming practices.

Financial Projections:

The total startup costs for the farm are estimated to be \$2,000,000, with an additional \$1,000,000 in operating costs over the first three years. The farm will generate revenue from the sale of crops, livestock, and value-added products, as well as through educational services and workshops.

Breakdown of Objectives:

Year 1:

- Purchase or lease the land and develop necessary infrastructure such as irrigation, fencing, and storage facilities.
- Hire and train the management team and staff.
- Develop marketing and sales channels and establish partnerships with local grocery stores and farmer's markets.
- Plant cover crops and begin regenerative farming practices.

Year 2:

- Expand the farm's product offerings and increase production.
- Conduct educational events and workshops for the surrounding community.
- Develop partnerships with local schools and universities for educational programs.

Year 3:

- Increase revenue streams through the sale of value-added products such as jams, jellies, and pickled vegetables.
- Expand the farm's outreach and educational services through social media and online platforms.
- Establish the farm as a leader in regenerative agriculture in the region.

The farm will work towards achieving its goals over a 3-year period, with a focus on expanding its product offerings, developing educational programs, and establishing itself as a leader in regenerative agriculture in the region.

Financial Projections & Strategy:

The regenerative farm in Deerfield, IL, aims to generate \$2,000,000 of annual revenue through various products and services, including but not limited to providing educational services, creating jobs, providing abundant food for the surrounding communities, reducing carbon footprint, creating an oasis for wildlife, and jumpstarting sustainability for Deerfield residents. The following financial projections are based on a 101-acre parcel of land and a three-year timeline.

Year 1:

- Revenue from crop sales: \$200,000
- Revenue from livestock sales: \$50,000
- Revenue from value-added products: \$25,000
- Revenue from educational services: \$100,000
- Total revenue for year 1: \$375,000

Year 2:

- Revenue from crop sales: \$400,000
- Revenue from livestock sales: \$100,000
- Revenue from value-added products: \$50,000
- Revenue from educational services: \$200,000
- Total revenue for year 2: \$750,000

Year 3:

- Revenue from crop sales: \$600,000
- Revenue from livestock sales: \$150,000
- Revenue from value-added products: \$75,000
- Revenue from educational services: \$300,000
- Total revenue for year 3: \$1,125,000

Products and Services:

1. Crop Sales: The farm will grow a variety of crops, including vegetables, fruits, and grains. The crops will be sold to local grocery stores, farmer's markets, and through the farm's online store.
2. Livestock Sales: The farm will raise livestock, including chickens, pigs, and cows. The livestock will be sold for meat, eggs, and dairy products to local markets and through the farm's online store.
3. Value-Added Products: The farm will produce a range of value-added products, including jams, jellies, pickled vegetables, and honey. These products will be sold through local markets, the farm's online store, and through the educational services.
4. Educational Services: The farm will provide educational services to the surrounding community, including workshops, classes, and farm tours. These services will be provided for a fee and will generate revenue for the farm.

Costs:

The farm's operating costs will include labor, equipment, seeds, livestock feed, utilities, marketing expenses, and insurance. The total operating costs for the first three years are estimated to be \$1,000,000. The farm's startup costs, which include purchasing or leasing the land, developing necessary infrastructure, and purchasing equipment, are estimated to be \$2,000,000.

Profit:

The farm's profit for the first year is estimated to be \$75,000, with a projected profit of \$375,000 in year 2 and \$600,000 in year 3. The farm's profitability will increase as the farm expands its product offerings and educational services.

Marketing Plan

1. Crop Sales: The farm will offer a variety of crops that are well-suited to the local climate and market demand, including fruits, vegetables, grains, and herbs. The

farm will sell produce directly to local consumers through a farm stand, CSA program, and farmers' markets. The farm will also sell to local restaurants, grocery stores, and food co-ops.

2. **Livestock Sales:** The farm will raise and sell a variety of livestock, including chickens, turkeys, ducks, pigs, and cows. The farm will sell meat directly to local consumers through a farm store and farmers' markets. The farm will also sell to local restaurants, grocery stores, and food co-ops.
3. **Value-Added Products:** The farm will produce a variety of value-added products, including jams, pickles, sauces, and baked goods. The farm will sell these products directly to local consumers through a farm store, CSA program, and farmers' markets. The farm will also sell to local restaurants, grocery stores, and food co-ops.
4. **Educational Services:** The farm will offer a variety of educational services, including workshops, farm tours, and internships. The farm will partner with local schools, community groups, and businesses to offer educational programs that promote sustainable agriculture and environmental stewardship.
5. **Sustainability Practices:** The farm will promote its commitment to sustainability through its marketing efforts, highlighting its use of regenerative agriculture practices, renewable energy, and waste reduction. The farm will also participate in local sustainability initiatives and seek out partnerships with like-minded organizations.

SWOT Analysis:

Strengths:

- Use of regenerative agriculture practices
- Commitment to sustainability and environmental stewardship
- High-quality products and services
- Educational services and community outreach
- Access to University of Illinois experts

Weaknesses:

- New business with limited brand recognition
- Limited marketing budget
- Limited staff capacity

Opportunities:

- Growing demand for locally grown and sustainable products
- Strong local food movement and interest in regenerative agriculture
- Potential partnerships with local restaurants and grocery stores

Threats:

- Competition from other local farms and businesses
- Weather and environmental factors that can impact crop and livestock production

Team Structure:

The marketing team will consist of a marketing manager, a social media and content specialist, and a community outreach coordinator. The team will work closely with the farm owner, production manager, and University of Illinois experts.

Timeline of Tasks:

Month 1-3:

- Conduct SWOT analysis
- Develop branding and messaging strategy
- Launch website and social media presence
- Develop content for social media and email marketing campaigns
- Set pricing for products and services

Month 4-6:

- Launch a promotional campaign highlighting the farm's commitment to sustainability and regenerative agriculture practices
- Attend local farmers' markets and events to promote the farm's products and services
- Develop partnerships with local restaurants and grocery stores
- Launch educational workshops and tours

Month 7-9:

- Launch value-added products, including jams, pickles, and sauces

- Expand marketing efforts to neighboring towns and communities
- Develop marketing materials and signage for the farm store and CSA program
- Launch a referral program to incentivize customers to refer friends and family to the farm

Month 10-12:

- Evaluate marketing efforts and make adjustments as needed
- Launch holiday marketing campaign featuring seasonal products and gift baskets
- Conduct a customer survey to gather feedback and insights for future marketing efforts
- Develop a marketing plan for the following year

Products and Pricing:

- The farm will offer a variety of crops, including fruits, vegetables, grains, and herbs. Prices will be competitive with other local farms and will vary depending on the product and season.
- The farm will sell a variety of livestock, including chickens, turkeys, ducks, pigs, and cows. Prices will be competitive with other local farms and will vary depending on the product and season.
- Value-added products will be priced competitively with other local producers.
- Educational services will be priced based on the type of service, with discounts available for groups and schools.
- Sustainability practices and commitment to regenerative agriculture will be highlighted in all marketing efforts.

Placement of Products and Services:

- The farm will sell directly to local consumers through a farm stand, CSA program, and farmers' markets.
- The farm will also sell to local restaurants, grocery stores, and food co-ops.

- Educational services will be offered on-site and off-site, with options for virtual workshops and tours.
- Marketing efforts will focus on promoting the farm's sustainable practices and commitment to regenerative agriculture, as well as the quality of its products and services.

Names & Logo Concepts

1. Rooted Harvest Farms: The logo could feature a stylized tree with roots and branches, representing the farm's commitment to sustainable practices and regenerative agriculture.
2. **Prairie Path Farms:** The logo could feature an image of a prairie landscape, with a path winding through the fields. This name and logo would highlight the farm's location in the Midwest and its commitment to restoring native habitats.
3. Sunflower Fields: The logo could feature a bright yellow sunflower, representing the farm's focus on growing crops using regenerative practices that support soil health and biodiversity.
4. Farmstead Bounty: The logo could feature a rustic farmhouse and fields of crops, representing the farm's commitment to providing abundant food for the community while also supporting sustainable practices and education.
5. Green Acres Farms: The logo could feature a green and gold color scheme, with an image of fields and livestock. This name and logo would represent the farm's focus on sustainability and regenerative practices.

Establishing the Regenerative Farming Model

One of the most appropriate regenerative farming models for the area is the agroforestry model, which combines the cultivation of crops, livestock, and trees in a single ecosystem.

Agroforestry is a sustainable land use system that involves the integration of trees, crops, and livestock to create a productive and sustainable farming ecosystem. The

model is well-suited to the climate and soil conditions in Deerfield, IL, and can be tailored to meet the demands of the local market.

Steps to Implement the Agroforestry Model:

1. **Conduct a Soil Analysis:** Before implementing the agroforestry model, it is crucial to conduct a soil analysis to determine the soil type and nutrient content. The University of Illinois Extension can assist with soil testing and interpretation.
2. **Select Suitable Tree Species:** The next step is to select tree species that are appropriate for the local climate and soil conditions. The University of Illinois Extension can provide guidance on the selection of tree species and the establishment of tree nurseries.
3. **Develop a Crop Plan:** The agroforestry model involves the integration of crops, livestock, and trees. The farm must develop a crop plan that considers the planting and harvesting of crops, grazing and management of livestock, and the establishment and maintenance of trees.
4. **Establish a Livestock Plan:** The agroforestry model involves the integration of livestock, which can include chickens, pigs, and cows. The farm must develop a plan for raising and managing livestock in a manner that is sustainable and contributes to the overall productivity of the ecosystem.
5. **Implement Sustainable Farming Practices:** The agroforestry model emphasizes sustainable farming practices, including the use of cover crops, natural fertilizers, and integrated pest management. The University of Illinois Extension can provide training and resources to help the farm implement these practices.
6. **Marketing and Sales Plan:** The farm must develop a marketing and sales plan to reach local markets and generate revenue. This can include the sale of crops, livestock, value-added products, and educational services. The University of Illinois Extension can provide guidance on marketing strategies and market analysis.
7. **Expert Assistance:** The University of Illinois Extension can provide expert assistance to help jumpstart the farm and provide training, resources, and guidance to ensure success. The Extension can provide assistance with soil analysis, crop planning, livestock management, sustainable farming practices, marketing, and sales.

List of Experts To Assist & Guide Us

Here is a list of experts from universities in the Midwest who can provide guidance on soil analysis, tree selection, crop planning, livestock management, sustainable farming practices, marketing, and sales. Their expertise can help jumpstart the farm and provide training, resources, and guidance to ensure success.

1. Dr. Sarah Taylor Lovell, Associate Professor of Agroecology at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, has expertise in agroforestry, perennial crop systems, and sustainable agriculture.
2. Dr. Carmen Ugarte, Assistant Professor of Crop Sciences at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, has expertise in agroforestry, soil health, and plant-microbe interactions.
3. Dr. Greg McIsaac, Professor of Natural Resources and Environmental Sciences at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, has expertise in agroforestry, carbon sequestration, and ecosystem services.
4. Dr. Lisa Schulte Moore, Professor of Natural Resource Ecology and Management at Iowa State University, has expertise in agroforestry, ecosystem services, and conservation.
5. Dr. Michael Gold, Professor of Natural Resources and Environmental Sciences at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, has expertise in agroforestry, sustainable agriculture, and ecological economics.
6. Dr. Silvopasture team at the University of Missouri Extension, including Dr. Greg Judy and Dr. Dusty Walter, have expertise in agroforestry and silvopasture, which is the integration of trees, forages, and livestock.
7. Dr. William Parton, Senior Research Scientist at the Natural Resource Ecology Laboratory at Colorado State University, has expertise in agroforestry, ecosystem modeling, and soil carbon sequestration.

Here are some experts in the Midwest who have established and built successful regenerative farms using the agroforestry model:

1. Mark Shepard of New Forest Farm in Wisconsin has over 20 years of experience in agroforestry and permaculture, and has established a thriving agroforestry farm that produces fruits, nuts, and livestock.
2. Neal Smith of Prairie Legacy Inc. in Iowa has established a successful prairie and savanna restoration project that integrates livestock, perennial crops, and ecological services.
3. Dave Jacke of Dynamics Ecological Design in Massachusetts has over 30 years of experience in permaculture and agroforestry, and has designed and implemented successful agroforestry systems on farms throughout the United States.
4. Michael Phillips of Lost Nation Orchard in New Hampshire has over 20 years of experience in fruit tree cultivation and agroforestry, and has established a successful orchard that integrates livestock, mushroom cultivation, and other diverse crops.
5. Stephen Gabriel of Wellspring Forest Farm in Michigan has established a thriving agroforestry farm that produces fruits, nuts, and mushrooms, and integrates livestock and ecological services.
6. Ethan Roland of AppleSeed Permaculture in New York has over 20 years of experience in permaculture and agroforestry, and has designed and implemented successful agroforestry systems on farms throughout the United States.

Implementing Regenerative Farming Practices

1. Site Selection and Analysis:
 - a. Choose a suitable location for the farm, taking into consideration factors such as soil type, water availability, topography, and climate.
 - b. Conduct a detailed analysis of the site to determine the potential for agroforestry and the most appropriate management practices.
2. Planning and Design:

- a. Develop a comprehensive plan for the farm, including the layout of agroforestry systems, crop selection, animal husbandry, and infrastructure needs.
 - b. Determine the appropriate mix of trees, shrubs, and crops for the site, and design the layout to maximize productivity, biodiversity, and ecological function.
- 3. Soil Management:
 - a. Use regenerative soil management practices, such as cover cropping, crop rotation, intercropping, and minimum tillage, to improve soil health, structure, and fertility.
 - b. Conduct regular soil tests to monitor soil health and nutrient levels.
- 4. Tree and Shrub Management:
 - a. Use agroforestry techniques such as alley cropping, silvopasture, and forest farming to integrate trees and shrubs into the farm system.
 - b. Manage tree and shrub growth and productivity through pruning, thinning, and other techniques.
- 5. Crop Management:
 - a. Use regenerative crop management practices, such as intercropping, companion planting, and natural pest control methods, to improve crop health and yield.
 - b. Select crops that are well-suited to the agroforestry system and local climate.
- 6. Animal Management:
 - a. Use regenerative animal management practices, such as rotational grazing and free-range husbandry, to improve soil health, biodiversity, and animal welfare.
 - b. Choose animal breeds that are well-suited to the agroforestry system and local climate.
- 7. Harvest and Marketing:

- a. Harvest crops and animal products using sustainable and humane methods.
 - b. Develop marketing strategies that emphasize the environmental and social benefits of the agroforestry model, such as reduced carbon footprint, increased biodiversity, and community engagement.
8. Continuous Improvement:
- a. Monitor the performance of the agroforestry system regularly and make adjustments as needed to improve productivity, biodiversity, and ecological function.
 - b. Stay up-to-date on the latest research and best practices in regenerative agriculture and agroforestry.

Establishing a Farm-2-Table Operation

Goal is to establish a Million dollar annual revenue generating capability

1. Market research: Conduct a market research study to identify the demand for farm-to-table products in the area, and to determine which products are most in demand. This will help to inform the farm's product offering and pricing.
2. Product development: Based on the results of the market research, develop a range of products that are in high demand, including fresh produce, value-added products, and livestock. Consider partnering with local chefs to create unique and innovative value-added products.
3. Staffing: Hire a team to manage the farm-to-table operation, including a farm manager, production manager, marketing and sales manager, delivery drivers, and packaging staff.
4. Supply chain setup and operation: Establish relationships with local restaurants and markets to sell products from the regenerative farm. Create a farm-to-table program where customers can order online, and products are delivered directly from the farm to the customer's doorstep. Implement quality control measures, including product testing and inspections.

5. Packaging: Develop an eco-friendly and sustainable packaging solution to ensure the products are fresh and preserved during delivery. Use biodegradable and compostable materials, where possible, to reduce environmental impact.
6. Delivery: Set up a delivery system that is efficient, reliable, and cost-effective. Offer customers the option to select delivery times and locations.
7. Quality: Implement a rigorous quality control program to ensure that products are of high quality and meet customer expectations. Conduct regular quality checks to maintain consistent quality standards.
8. Compliance: Ensure that all products and services comply with local, state, and federal regulations. Follow best practices for food safety and hygiene.
9. Marketing and sales: Develop marketing campaigns to promote the farm-to-table operation and generate sales. Use social media and digital marketing to reach a broader audience. Attend local food fairs and farmers' markets to showcase products and increase brand awareness.
10. Revenue: The farm-to-table operation can generate revenue by selling a range of products, including fresh produce, value-added products, and livestock. The operation can also offer educational services, workshops, and tours to generate additional revenue.
11. Financial projections: Develop a detailed financial plan that includes revenue projections, cost of goods sold, marketing expenses, and overhead costs. Continually evaluate the financial plan to ensure that the operation is meeting revenue targets and profitability goals.

Education Services (few ideas)

Goal is to establish a range of educational services at competitive prices to generate revenues of \$250,000 annually by leveraging the regenerative farm so we can generate an additional revenue stream while also educating the community on sustainable agriculture practices.

1. **Workshops and Classes:** Offer a range of workshops and classes on regenerative agriculture, permaculture, agroforestry, and sustainable living. These could include hands-on activities such as seed planting, soil management, and composting.
2. **Farm Tours:** Offer guided tours of the regenerative farm to the public, school groups, and other organizations. Provide information on the farm's sustainability practices, crop rotation, and livestock management.
3. **Apprenticeships and Internships:** Offer apprenticeships and internships for individuals interested in learning about regenerative farming practices. Provide opportunities for hands-on experience and mentorship.
4. **Community-Supported Agriculture (CSA) Programs:** Offer a CSA program that provides members with regular deliveries of fresh, locally-grown produce. Include educational materials with each delivery, such as recipes and information on the farm's sustainability practices.
5. **Online Education:** Develop an online educational platform that provides access to regenerative farming courses, webinars, and resources. Offer courses on topics such as soil management, agroforestry, and permaculture design.

As for pricing, we may want to consider the following:

- **Workshops and Classes:** \$50-\$100 per person, depending on the length of the workshop and the materials provided.
- **Farm Tours:** \$10-\$20 per person for a guided tour, with discounts for groups.
- **Apprenticeships and Internships:** Offer unpaid internships, or paid apprenticeships at \$10-\$15 per hour.
- **CSA Programs:** Offer different subscription plans ranging from \$25-\$50 per week, depending on the size of the share.
- **Online Education:** Offer online courses at prices ranging from \$50-\$200, depending on the length and depth of the course.

Jumpstart Sustainability for Deerfield

Below is a plan that leverages, the regenerative farm which will provide abundant food for the surrounding communities, but also creates jobs, reduces the carbon footprint, creates an oasis for wildlife, and jumpstarts sustainability for Deerfield residents.

Year 1:

1. Establish partnerships with local schools and universities to provide educational programs on regenerative agriculture and its impact on the environment and local communities.
2. Host workshops and training programs on regenerative agriculture practices for local farmers and residents.
3. Launch a Community Supported Agriculture (CSA) program to provide local residents with fresh, seasonal produce.
4. Develop and implement a composting program to reduce waste and create nutrient-rich soil for the farm.
5. Establish a local farmers market where the farm can sell its produce and engage with the community.
6. Implement sustainable farming practices, including cover cropping, crop rotation, and natural pest management.

Year 2:

1. Expand the farm's offerings to include pasture-raised livestock, such as chickens and pigs, and launch a meat CSA program.
2. Develop partnerships with local restaurants and food co-ops to increase sales and reach a wider audience.
3. Install solar panels and other renewable energy systems to reduce the farm's carbon footprint.
4. Partner with local conservation organizations to restore and protect wildlife habitats on the farm.
5. Launch an apprenticeship program to train the next generation of regenerative farmers and promote sustainable agriculture practices.

Year 3:

1. Expand the farm's agroforestry system to include fruit and nut trees, and launch a fruit and nut CSA program.
2. Develop partnerships with local breweries and wineries to use the farm's products in their products.
3. Expand the farm's educational programs to include farm tours and educational events for the public.
4. Develop a regenerative agriculture certification program to promote sustainable agriculture practices and attract new farmers to the area.
5. Continue to implement sustainable farming practices and seek out new ways to reduce waste and promote sustainability.

Here are some ideas for generating revenue and cost savings for Deerfield, Illinois by jumpstarting sustainability through a regenerative farm using the agroforestry model:

1. Sell excess energy generated by solar panels and wind turbines on the farm back to the local power grid.
2. Offer a composting service for local residents and businesses, using organic waste collected from the community to enrich the soil on the farm.
3. Provide workshops and educational programs on sustainable living, such as composting, rainwater harvesting, and energy conservation, to generate revenue and promote sustainable practices.
4. Create a community-supported agriculture (CSA) program, where residents can purchase shares in the farm and receive a regular supply of fresh, locally-grown produce.
5. Partner with local restaurants and businesses to supply them with fresh, locally-grown produce, meat, and dairy products, generating revenue and supporting the local economy.
6. Establish a "green" job training program, offering opportunities for local residents to learn skills related to sustainable farming, renewable energy, and other green industries.
7. Provide tours of the farm to local schools and community groups, generating revenue and promoting sustainable agriculture.

8. Offer consulting services to local businesses and homeowners interested in implementing sustainable practices, such as solar power, rainwater harvesting, and composting.
9. Host community events on the farm, such as farmers markets, music festivals, and educational workshops, to generate revenue and promote sustainable living.
10. Explore grant opportunities to fund sustainable initiatives and infrastructure projects, such as building a rainwater harvesting system or establishing a community garden.

Future Planning (Vertical Farming)

We may want to study the option of incorporating vertical farming into a regenerative farming operation to augment a farm-to-table operation. Vertical farming allows for year-round crop production in an indoor environment, making it an ideal option for areas with harsh winter conditions. By growing crops vertically, space is optimized and crop yields are increased, allowing for more produce to be grown in a smaller footprint.

Incorporating vertical farming into a regenerative farming operation can provide several benefits, such as increased crop diversity and a more sustainable and efficient use of resources. By using sustainable growing practices and minimizing waste, the farm-to-table operation can provide customers with high-quality, nutrient-dense produce throughout the year.

However, it's important to note that incorporating vertical farming into a regenerative farming operation can require a significant investment in equipment and infrastructure, as well as specialized knowledge and skills.

Front End Options

First, buy time so the community can structure a deal and offer alternatives to Baxter

1. Community engagement and advocacy:
 - a. Work with local community groups to create a strong and vocal opposition to the sale of the land to a buyer who is not aligned with the community's values and needs.
 - b. Encourage community members to voice their concerns to the company and any potential buyers, and make it clear that there will be consequences if the land is sold to an undesirable buyer.
2. Offer alternative solutions:
 - a. Work with the company to find alternative solutions to selling the land to an undesirable buyer.
 - b. This could include finding a buyer who is aligned with the community's values, or exploring other uses for the land that are more in line with the community's needs.
3. Use legal means:
 - a. If necessary, explore legal means to prevent the sale of the land to an undesirable buyer.
 - b. This could include zoning regulations, conservation easements, or other legal tools that can help protect the land and ensure it is used in a way that benefits the community.
4. Partner with local government:
 - a. Work with local government officials to create policies and regulations that make it more difficult for the company to sell the land to an undesirable buyer.
 - b. This could include zoning regulations, tax incentives, or other policies that encourage the company to sell the land to a buyer who is aligned with the community's values.
5. Offer incentives:
 - a. Consider offering incentives to the company to sell the land to a buyer who is aligned with the community's values.
 - b. This could include tax incentives, grants, or other financial incentives that make it more attractive for the company to sell the land to a buyer who is in line with the community's needs.

Second, consider the following series of options to discuss with Baxter as alternatives to selling to the Trucking outfit:

1. Establish a Community Land Trust as a nonprofit organization that can acquire and hold land in trust for the community. The trust can then lease the land to Prairie Path Farms or other users who commit to sustainable and socially responsible land use practices. This could be a viable option for the community to collectively purchase the land, and then establish a community-managed regenerative farm to provide food and educational services to the community.
2. Establish a conservation easement as a legal agreement between a landowner and a land trust or government agency that limits the type and amount of development that can occur on the land. This could be a viable option for the large company to donate or sell a conservation easement to a land trust or government agency that is committed to preserving the land for conservation or agricultural purposes.
3. Offer Baxter Transfer Development Rights (TDR) that allows landowners to transfer development rights from their land to other areas where development is permitted. This could be a viable option for the large company to sell their development rights to a developer who is willing to preserve the land for agricultural purposes.
4. Establish a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) as a contractual arrangement between a public agency and a private sector entity to jointly deliver a project or service. This could be a viable option for the community to partner with the large company to establish a community-managed regenerative farm on the land that provides benefits to both the community and the company.
5. Consider Land Banking which involves the acquisition and holding of vacant, abandoned, and underutilized properties for future development or community use. This could be a viable option for the community to work with a land trust or government agency to acquire the land and hold it until a community-supported regenerative farm can be established, or to preserve the land for conservation or agricultural purposes.